

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Laughter is the best medicine!



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have any techniques for calming yourself down when you're nervous?
- When was the last time you had to speak or perform in public?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about health and wellness.
- I can talk about what has happened or what I've done.
- I can report statements.





Let's Explore!

Fake it 'till you make it*.

* "Fake it 'till you make it" means to pretend to be good at something until you actually become good at it.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

We all know that tension and worry often affect us physically. Some people even report that they feel ill due to strain and pressure. (Who has not written at least one test in school that made them sick?) Doctors warn that those who are tense and worried over a long period of time may well develop real illnesses. The mind affects the body. Conversely, when we feel relaxed, our bodies simply feel better. Consider singing. Have you ever sung in the shower with no one around to see you or hear you? It is not difficult to let loose freely with a song. Now imagine you have just been asked to sing on a stage in front of people. Most of us will admit that we become quite nervous and tense in front of people. Some will even report that butterflies are too much to bear, and that they cannot sing at all.

One reputable drama teacher states that yawning is a great way to battle nerves. She says that when you yawn and stretch, your body naturally relaxes itself. All you have to do is seriously start pretending to yawn, and then your body will take over and you will really start yawning! Some people brush this technique off as being wacky and unproven, but she always asks the doubters what they have to lose. She tells them that the worst that can happen is that they feel a little sleepy.

Another wonderful way to relax is by laughing. Some doctors recommend it as a deliberate exercise to be done every day. Again, start laughing by just doing it, and then the body will naturally take over. Knowing how to relax is important. Modern performers have been very aware of this. In order to become fit, they have begun paying attention to stress management. If you've been backstage at a race or a show recently, you have certainly seen an artist or two laughing and yawning. They're not tired or giggly, they're just trying to reduce their anxiety. I guess they are just trying to fake it 'till they make it!





Let's Practice!

Let's talk about relaxation techniques.

Instructions: Complete the word search according to the hints that you are given. Use the vocabulary to model a conversation with a partner. Switch roles.

Hints

1. The state of being strained or nervous
2. Sickness
3. Open the mouth wide and exhale air when tired
4. Weird or strange
5. Describing something that has not been shown to be true
6. To laugh constantly
7. The feeling that you get in your stomach

U	N	S	M	G	I	G	G	L	E	R	P	G	V	Z
V	U	E	I	J	J	W	A	C	K	Y	Q	E	G	E
E	T	I	Z	O	H	T	P	E	F	B	O	Z	J	E
T	E	L	K	K	L	E	M	T	U	B	A	E	E	R
Y	N	F	F	B	P	O	D	L	N	O	O	R	J	B
X	S	R	H	T	R	L	E	B	P	H	W	I	V	J
V	I	E	H	C	R	U	D	J	R	W	V	L	C	Z
Z	O	T	G	H	R	W	D	T	O	X	O	L	C	T
D	N	T	W	M	L	Z	R	H	V	R	P	N	D	A
R	M	U	G	X	M	I	D	D	E	T	H	E	V	O
T	A	B	S	X	D	S	C	F	N	J	T	S	E	O
D	T	L	R	Y	A	W	N	U	Z	I	D	S	J	X
M	H	C	R	F	L	V	B	E	Q	U	C	L	R	X
W	P	Y	V	R	P	O	U	M	R	Q	R	Y	C	Z
Z	C	A	P	V	N	I	M	Q	A	R	D	S	M	N



Let's Practice!

What do doctors say about treating anxiety?

Instructions: Complete the sentences below by choosing from the options that you are given. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

that when you yawn and stretch

warn that those who are tense and worried

admit that we become quite nervous and tense

that the worst that can happen

report that they feel ill due to the straining

1. Some people even _____ and pressure.
2. Doctors _____ over a long period of time may develop real illnesses.
3. Most of us will _____ in front of people.
4. She says _____, your body naturally relaxes itself.
5. She tells them _____ is that they feel a little sleepy.



Extension Activity

Write a list of tips for overcoming nervousness.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research tips for overcoming nervousness.
- Write down your ten favorite tips.
- Share your tips with a partner.
- Compare your list with your partner's list.
- Collaborate with your partner to create a new list of the five best tips.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research tips for overcoming nervousness.

☐☐

I make a list using the best tips.

☐☐

I share my tips with a partner.

☐☐

I work with a partner to combine lists.

☐☐

Target Words

- tension** (noun): the state of being strained or nervous
e.g. We all know that tension and worry often affect us physically.
- illness** (noun): sickness
e.g. Doctors warn that those who are tense and worried over a long period of time may well develop real illnesses.
- butterflies (in your stomach)** (expression): a feeling of nervousness
e.g. Some will even report that the butterflies are too much to bear, and that they cannot sing at all.
- to yawn** (verb): to open the mouth wide and inhale air when tired
e.g. She says that when you yawn and stretch, your body naturally relaxes itself.
- wacky** (adjective): weird or strange
e.g. Some people brush this technique off as being wacky and unproven, but she always asks the doubters what they have to lose.
- unproven** (adjective): describing something that has not been shown to be true
e.g. Doctors will not endorse the unproven treatment.



Learning Points

Present Perfect: Present Results of Past Action

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

Use of the Present Perfect tense	Examples:
to talk about your experiences at any time unspecified in your life	<i>I have been to Europe. He has never tried sushi. Many people have experienced a language barrier in another country, but what they don't realize is that others may not understand their gestures, either!</i>
to talk about habitual actions or with state verbs, when the topic is related to now	<i>I've always preferred coffee to tea. She's never driven to work. They usually go for a walk after dinner.</i>
with time adverbs to say how long a situation has gone on up to the moment of speaking	<i>I've lived here for the past ten years. He's played the guitar since he was a child. We haven't seen Tom and Anita for ages!</i>

Examples:

- *Have you ever sung in the shower with no one around to see or hear you?*
- *Now imagine you have just been asked to sing on a stage in front of people.*
- *Modern performers have become very aware of this.*
- *If you've been backstage at a race or a show recently, you have certainly seen an artist or two laughing and yawning.*





Learning Points

Reporting with That-Clause and Wh-Clause

You use that- clauses and wh- clauses to report statements and questions in indirect speech.

You use reported speech to report statements or situations.

You use that- clauses to report someone else's thoughts or statements.

Example:

*Jo suggested **that I should go** exercise more.*

You use wh- clauses to report questions with wh- words like *why, when, what, who*, etc. With wh- clauses, you normally use verbs like *ask, want to know, wonder* to introduce the clause.

Example:

*Jo asked me **when I was going** to exercise next.*

Examples:

- *Doctors warn that those who are tense and worried over a long period of time may well develop real illnesses.*
- *Most of us will admit that we become quite nervous and tense in front of people.*
- *Some will even report that the butterflies are too much to bear, and that they cannot sing at all.*
- *One reputable drama teacher states that yawning is a great way to battle nerves.*
- *She says that when you yawn and stretch, your body naturally relaxes itself.*
- *She always asks the doubters what they have to lose.*

